

B0B04B22 - Anglický jazyk B2-2

WEEK 8

Relative Pronouns* / Defining and Non-defining Relative Clauses**

Key Word Sentence Transformation Practice

Prepositions & Vocabulary

Relative pronouns* are essential in academic English for constructing clear, concise, and complex sentences that connect ideas and provide necessary information, thereby enhancing the overall flow and coherence of academic texts. Their correct usage helps avoid redundancy and allows for the expression of detailed arguments and analyses, which is vital for scholarly communication and achieving successful publication.

Relative clauses** are vital in academic English for adding specific detail and complexity to sentences, allowing writers to pack more information into a single sentence and convey nuanced ideas clearly. They achieve this by modifying nouns and pronouns, providing essential defining information or additional descriptive detail, and improving the flow of discourse by connecting ideas across sentences. Mastering relative clauses enables more sophisticated, precise, and complex writing, which is a hallmark of academic written composition.

A CLAUSE is a unit of grammatical organization next below the sentence in rank and in traditional grammar said to consist of a subject and predicate (i.e., the part of a sentence or clause containing a verb and stating something about the subject (e.g. went home in John went home)).

A RELATIVE PRONOUN is a pronoun that is used to introduce a relative clause. The main English relative pronouns are **which, that, who**, and **whom**. These words can also function as other parts of speech - they are not exclusively used as relative pronouns. The possessive pronoun form of "who," **whose**, can also be used as a relative pronoun to indicate ownership. *NOTE: WHAT is not a Relative Pronoun in English.*

A RELATIVE CLAUSE introduces further information about the preceding noun or noun phrase, either helping to identify what it refers to (in a defining [restrictive] clause) or just providing extra details (in a non-defining [nonrestrictive] clause).

The relative clause comes after a noun or noun phrase (called the antecedent) and gives some additional information about the thing or person in question. The relative pronoun represents the antecedent.

DEFINING RELATIVE CLAUSES: specify a noun or pronoun in the main clause and are necessary if we want to understand the meaning of a sentence.

- I saw the girl **who** was outside our house.
- They wanted the picture **that** cost two pounds.

These relative clauses specify the objects of the main clauses. If we omit them, it is not clear what girl or picture we are talking about. The defining relative clauses follow after the relative pronouns who, which, that, whose and whom. We do not write them with commas.

Use of the relative pronouns

Who for people (and pet animals): • The man **who** called you has just arrived.

Which for things: • This is the book **which** I wanted.

That for people and things: • Are you the boy **that** lives next door?
• Can you see the tree **that** has no leaves?

The relative pronoun **that** is generally considered to be less formal than who or which (...and is used in **defining relative clauses only**).

Whose is a possessive pronoun for people and things:

- It is a story about a boy **whose** parents got divorced.
- The river **whose** bridge is in front of us is called the Cam.

Whom is the object of a verb: • The man **whom** I met yesterday... *NOTE: WHOM is not really tested on the B2 English Exam – it "might" appear once on 1 out of 10-20 exams.*

Whom is very formal. In spoken English **who** or **that** are much more common.

- The man **who** I met ... The man **that** I met...

We can also leave out the pronoun. It is the most usual form.

The man I met...

If the subject in the main clause is different from the subject in the defining relative clause, we normally leave out the relative pronoun.

- The student you saw in Oxford is my neighbour. (the subjects are the student and you)
- The bike she borrowed belongs to me. (the subjects are the bike and she)

BE CAREFUL

If the subject in the main clause and the relative clause is the same, we cannot omit the pronoun, because it becomes the subject of the relative clause.

- The driver **who** took you to school is from York. ("The driver took you to school is from York." does not make sense)
- The pen **that** is on the desk is new. ("The pen is on the desk is new." does not make sense)

There is only one subject in each sentence - the driver and the pen.

If we leave out the subject, it will not be clear what we mean.

NON-DEFINING RELATIVE CLAUSES:

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only describe a preceding noun or pronoun (add some information about them), but do not specify them. The non-defining relative clauses must be written with commas.

- My father, **who** is 65 now, still works.
- His car, **which** cost nearly 20,000 pounds, is broken.

If we leave out these relative clauses (My father still works. His car is broken.), the sentences remain grammatically correct and we know what father or car we are talking about. The only effect is that there is less information in the sentences.

More examples:

- I gave it to Peter, **who** is my close friend.
- Ann, **whom** I admire, is not right in this case.
- Pam, **whose** children go to school, is not so busy.

The non-defining relative clauses are quite formal and are typical of written English.

In spoken English we prefer less formal structures.

Written English: • My father, who is 65 now, still works.

Spoken English: • My father is 65 now and still works.

Written English: • Their garden, which is near here, looks beautiful.

Spoken English: • Their garden is near here. It looks beautiful.

PRACTICE:

This is EXACTLY what it will look like on the B2 Exam → EXCEPT, there will be 5 instead of 10.

Choose the correct answer (a, b, c or d) for each of the following sentences (1 – 10).

There is ONLY ONE correct answer for each sentence. **CIRCLE** your answer (a, b, c or d).

- (1) We don't know the person _____ donated this money.
a) , who b) , which c) what d) who
- (2) We drove past my old school _____ is celebrating its 100th anniversary this year.
a) which b) , which c) that d) , that
- (3) The 8.30 is the train _____ you need to get.
a) that b) what c) , which d) where
- (4) There was me and there was Kate _____ party it was, and then there were two other people.
a) that b) whose c) , whom d) , whose
- (5) Last year we spent our holidays in Scotland _____.
a) ,where is in the north of Great Britain b) which is in the north of Great Britain
c) , which is in the north of Great Britain d) that is in the north of Great Britain
- (6) I know a restaurant _____ the food is excellent.
a) that b) where c) which d) whose
- (7) There isn't a day _____ I don't feel rushed off my feet.
a) which b) , which c) when d) , where
- (8) My sister _____ spent her holiday in France.
a) that is 25 years old, b) is 25 years old, when she
c) who is 25 years old d) , who is 25 years old,
- (9) The house _____ windows are open is beautiful.
a) where b) that c) whose d) which
- (10) The letter _____ is in the drawer.
a) that Peter has sent to you b) , that Peter has sent to you,
c) , which Peter has sent to you, d) what Peter has sent to you

Add a modifying clause for time or location

WHEN - REPLACES AN OBJECT NOUN

When is a time-relative pronoun¹ that joins a modifying clause. In the example below, the clause modifies a noun phrase (*the years*) expressing a time, a temporal location.



The **years when** the "flower children" thrived were the 1960s.
The "flower children" thrived then.



The **day when** the concert takes place is Sunday.
The concert takes place then.



The **hour when** the parade begins is 12:30 p.m.
The parade begins then.

WHERE - REPLACES AN OBJECT NOUN

Where is a location-relative pronoun that joins a modifying clause. Below, the clause modifies a noun phrase (*the city*) which expresses a place, a physical location.



The **city where** "flower children" lived was San Francisco.
The "flower children" lived there.



The **site where** the concert will take place is Golden Gate Park.
The concert will be held there.



The **street where** the parade begins is Broadway.
The parade takes place there.

A PLACE—WHICH

Where can replace a relative pronoun for location—at which, on which or in which.

AT—ADDRESS, RESIDENCE, BUILDING

The house at which I live is nearby.

The address at which I work is 310 Elm Street.

The library at which I study is downtown.

ON—FLOOR, STREET, GEOGRAPHICAL LOCATION, PLANET

The floor on which I work is the twelfth.

The street on which I live is nearby.

The island on which I live is Puerto Rico.

IN—CITY, AREA, STATE, PROVINCE, COUNTRY

The room in which I work is here

The city in which I work is nearby

The country in which I pay taxes is Canada

A TIME—WHICH

When can replace a relative pronoun for location—at which, on which or in which.

AT—MOMENT, SECOND, HOUR

The moment at which he sent the text he fell.

The hour at which I eat lunch is 12:00–1:00 p.m.

The time at which I eat lunch is noon.

ON—DAY

The day on which I was born was snowy.

The day on which I was born was Tuesday.

The day on which I started school was June 1.

IN —MONTH, SEASON, YEAR, DECADE, CENTURY

The month in which I pay tax is April.

The season in which I vacation is summer.

The years in which I worked were 2017-2018.

An **identifying clause** adds information or narrows the noun to a specific one, group or lot. The clause helps by telling us **which one**. No commas are used. It is also called *restrictive*, *essential*, or *necessary clause*.

IDENTIFYING CLAUSE



A clause that identifies the noun before it (tells you *which one*) is not set off with commas. The object pronoun **when** or **where** may be omitted, however, some verbs may require a preposition to be included.

The area **where** the "flower children" lived was a neighborhood in San Francisco.

The area **in which** the "flower children" lived was a neighborhood in San Francisco.

The area ____ the "flower children" lived **in** was a neighborhood in San Francisco.
(The verb *live* requires adding/keeping the preposition *in*.)

The years **when** the "flower children" thrived was a colorful decade.

The years **in which** the "flower children" thrived was a colorful decade.

The years ____ the "flower children" thrived was a colorful decade.

A **nonidentifying clause** adds extra information about a noun already identified by other means, for example, by name, by shared knowledge or context. The clause, a comment, is set off with commas (before and, if necessary, after the clause). It is also called *nonrestrictive*, *nonessential*, or *unnecessary clause*.

NONIDENTIFYING CLAUSE



A clause that adds extra, nonidentifying information is set off with comma(s).

The object pronoun **when** or **where** is required (cannot be omitted) in a nonidentifying clause.

The Haight, **where** the "flower children" lived, was a neighborhood in San Francisco.

The Haight, **in which** the "flower children" lived, was a neighborhood in San Francisco.

*The Haight, ____ the "flower children" lived in, was a neighborhood in San Francisco.

The 1960s, **when** the "flower children" thrived, was a colorful decade.

The 1960s, **in which** the "flower children" thrived, was a colorful decade.

*The 1960s, ____ the "flower children" thrived, was a colorful decade.

***not used** / ~borderline or questionable usage

Key Word Sentence Transformations (Relative Pronouns)

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For each of the sentences below (1 - 8), complete the second sentence so that it has a similar meaning to the first sentence(s), using the word given for that sentence. **DO NOT CHANGE** the word given. You must use between two (2) and five (5) words, including the word given.

NOTE: ON THE B2 WRITTEN EXAM THERE WILL BE NO PUNCTUATION REQUIRED ON ANY KEY WORD SENTENCE TRANSFORMATION EXERCISE – IF PUNCTUATION IS ADDED, IT WILL VERY LIKELY CHANGE THE MEANING AND THEREFORE BE MARKED INCORRECT.

ADVICE: NEVER INCLUDE PUNCTUATION IN THE KEY WORD SENTENCE TRANSFORMATION ANSWERS ON THE B2 EXAM.

- (1) My cat just sleeps in front of the fire all day. THAT
I have _____ sleeps in front of the fire all day.
- (2) Queen Victoria was born in the year 1819. WHEN
1819 _____ Queen Victoria was born.
- (3) Both of her brothers are in the Navy. WHO
She has _____ in the Navy.
- (4) That man's dog bit me! WHOSE
That's the man _____ me!
- (5) We had this room redecorated last year. WHICH
This _____ we had decorated last year.
- (6) Whose fault was the fire at the factory? BLAME
Does anyone know _____ the fire at the factory?
- (7) That is the swimming pool. I swam there when I was younger. WHERE
That is the swimming pool _____ swimming.
- (8) She won the competition. I found that surprising. WHICH
She won the competition , _____.

NOW → DO YOU KNOW WHICH ONES NEED PUNCTUATION AND WHICH ONES DO NOT??

Complete the following sentences (1 - 5) according to the rules.

USE PUNCTUATION (COMMAS) WHERE NECESSARY.

- (1) She has two watches. She bought one of them in Paris. That one is faulty. THAT
The watch _____ is faulty.
- (2) Carol decided to leave our town. Her daughter had been killed. WHOSE
Carol _____ decided to leave our town.
- (3) All visitors to the museum are asked to sign the visitors' book. VISITS
Everyone _____ asked to sign the visitors' book.
- (4) A girl was injured in the accident. She is now in hospital. WHO
The girl _____ accident is now in hospital.
- (5) You said many rude words in the lesson. It was totally inappropriate to say those words. WHICH
You said many rude words in the lesson _____.

Preposition Practice (from the materials on pages 1 - 7):

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Complete the following sentences by filling in the blank spaces (1 - 24) with the proper preposition. Use only one word for each blank space.

- (1) We were just talking _____ Simon's new girlfriend.
- (2) The relative pronoun 'that' can never be used _____ a comma.
- (3) There were two unconfirmed sightings of UFOs _____ the area.
- (4) The object _____ the game is to improve children's math skills.
- (5) In a message posted _____ their website, the band said they were devastated by Mr Johnson's death.
- (6) We arrived _____ the airport, checked our baggage and wandered around the gift shops.
- (7) Let's go for a walk instead _____ playing video games.
- (8) This is the same room we stayed _____ last year.
- (9) If you are at all dissatisfied, simply return your order within 30 days of purchase for a refund _____ the unit price.
- (10) Anna was born _____ 1923 in Ardwick, a suburb of Manchester.
- (11) The winners are _____ follows - Woods, Smith and Cassidy.
- (12) Articles for the press should be written _____ double spacing and wide margins.
- (13) My dad was _____ the army, so we moved around a lot.
- (14) I have great respect _____ his ideas, although I don't agree with them.
- (15) Can you tell the meaning _____ this word from its context?
- (16) No artificial sweeteners are used _____ this product.
- (17) When you tell stories about yourself, you usually leave _____ the parts that are unflattering or embarrassing.
- (18) This painting is typical _____ his early work.
- (19) You shouldn't complain _____ what's wrong, just be grateful for what's right.
- (20) Instead of spending money _____ personal things, invest in professional things that make you smarter, skilled and more self-aware.
- (21) Many _____ us may be eating food containing GM ingredients without realizing it.
- (22) I recognize you...we went _____ the same high school.
- (23) Our neighbors usually watch our dog when we go _____ vacation.
- (24) Investigative journalism presupposes some level _____ investigation.

Vocabulary Practice (selected vocab from the materials on pages 1 - 7):**[Page 9]**

Complete the following sentences (1 - 25) by filling in the blank spaces with **the proper form of the word given for that sentence.**

You may use ONLY ONE word per blank space: DO NOT add any words [e.g. prepositions].

- (1) ADMINISTRATIVE In order to _____ effectively, the colonial powers were interested in establishing communities with clearly defined rulers.
- (2) ARRIVE His _____ brought complete silence to the room.
- (3) CAREFUL A _____ mistake cost the company millions of dollars.
- (4) CELEBRATE There were lively New Year _____ all over town.
- (5) COMPETITION Though she's almost 40, she still plans to _____ in the upcoming event.
- (6) DONATE Would you like to make a _____ to our charity appeal?
- (7) FOOL His _____ behaviour may jeopardize his whole future.
- (8) HOSPITAL Several students were _____ as a result of injuries suffered during the protest.
- (9) IMPORTANT The report emphasizes the _____ of improving safety standards.
- (10) INJURY A bomb exploded at the embassy, _____ several people.
- (11) LEAVE Air travellers were _____ stranded because of icy conditions.
- (12) MEMORY I haven't seen them since that _____ evening when the boat capsized.
- (13) NECESSARY The vaccination doesn't _____ make you completely immune.
- (14) POSSESSIVE I'm afraid he doesn't _____ a sense of humour.
- (15) PREFER Staying at home is certainly _____ to going out with someone you don't like.
- (16) PREPARE The team blamed injuries and lack of _____ for their failure to win.
- (17) PREVENT Doctors are aiming to concentrate more on _____ than cure.
- (18) RELATIVE Researchers are trying to _____ low exam results to larger class sizes.
- (19) RELAXATION Travelling by train is more _____ than driving.
- (20) RESERVATION Could I _____ two seats for tomorrow evening's performance?
- (21) SIGN Someone stole my credit card and forged my _____.
- (22) SPEAK He needs to perfect his _____ English before going to work in Canada.
- (23) SPECIFY Is there anything _____ you would like from the shops?
- (24) WRITTEN It's really difficult to read your _____.
- (25) YOUNG I was a fairly good football player in my _____.